- `next start`—Starts the production server, serving the built application
- `next export`—Creates a static export of your application, suitable for hosting on platforms like Netlify or Vercel

We will use these commands for building the project while developing the new service.

2.7.1 Setting up

Let's look at the code that uses Next.js instead of React/Express.js. You still need to have Node.js installed on your system before you run the project. Follow the instructions to access the code and run it on your system.

The code for this `chat-client-next` example project can be found in the ch02/chat-client-next folder. You can use this example by running this command in the source folder:

```
$ npm run dev -w ch02/chat-client-next
```

There are two AI provider options. This book's appendix offers instructions on how to set up and create a secret key for AI providers. The first option is Google generative AI, which this application uses by default as its primary LLM. Add your Gemini API key:

```
// .env
GEMINI_API_KEY=<SECRET_KEY>
```

Then, navigate to the `/` path in your browser to use the Gemini AI version of the application.

The second option is Open AI. Navigate to the `/chat-openai` path in your browser to use the OpenAI version of the application. First, you need the OpenAI API key (after providing your credit card, initial minimum $5 payment, and pay-as-you-go charges via invoices):

```
 // .env
OPENAI_API_KEY=<SECRET_KEY>
```

> **NOTE** For detailed instructions on how to create and configure API keys for both OpenAI and Google Gemini, including important billing considerations and free tier availability, see the appendix.

2.7.2 Running the project

If you followed the instructions for running the chat-client-next example project in the previous section, you should be able to visit `http://localhost:3000` and interact with the agent. It's basically the same application, so I won't post the same screenshot. However, now there are some key differences in the way that the application is structured. We explore some fundamentals on Next.js while we explore the codebase.